Lesson 05: Project: A Virtual City Tour

English Stage 1 (B1) · Unit 1: People and Places

Adapted from Speaking, Listening and Pronunciation Projects for ELLs - Intermediate Level by Brittany Zemlick, Grossmont College (CC BY 4.0): 1.8: Unit Project- City Virtual Tour.

In this lesson

You will make a short video tour of a city you know well, like the video "25 Things to do in Berlin". You will plan, write and memorize a 2 to 4 minute presentation about three interesting places in the city. You will use the vocabulary and the pronunciation (stress, vowels, consonants and linking) from this unit.

Learning goals

After this lesson you should be able to:

- Plan a short presentation about three places in a city you know well.
- Use phrases for describing places, such as "dates back to" and "head over to".
- Write a draft with 2-3 sentences about each place.
- Give a memorized 2-4 minute presentation on video, with good volume and eye contact.
- Check your own video with the book's rubric.

Key language

Word or phrase	Meaning in simple English	Example
one of the largest	among the biggest	Balboa Park is one of the largest parks in San Diego.
dates back to	was made or started at a time in the past	Old Town, San Diego dates back to the 18th century.
You can't come to ... and not ...	you must do this when you visit; don't miss it	You can't come to San Diego and not visit the beaches.
head over to	an informal way to say "go"	You can also head over to Belmont Park.
This ... actually used to be ...	in the past, this place was something different	These cafes actually used to be old warehouses.
Every ... people flock to ...	many people go to a place at the same time, again and again	Every weekend people flock to the beach.
born and raised	born and grew up in a place	I was born and raised in San Diego.
tourist destination	a place many visitors travel to	San Diego is a well-known tourist destination.

Word or phrase	Meaning in simple English	Example
site	a place where something important is or happened	It's the site of the first Spanish settlement in California.
eye contact	looking at people (in a video: at the camera) when you speak	Look directly at the camera.
volume	how loud your voice is	Speak loudly enough to be heard comfortably.

Rules and explanations

The task (for self-study)

In the book, groups of 3 make one video, and each student describes one place. You will do the whole video alone:

- Choose a city (or another interesting location) that you know well.
- Choose 3 places or sites in that city. For each place, say its name, why it is important or interesting to you, and what a tourist can do there.
- Use at least 3 phrases or vocabulary words from the "25 Things to do in Berlin" video.
- Show at least one picture for each place (3 pictures minimum). You can use slides or photos, but they must be in your video.
- Your presentation must be 2 to 4 minutes long. Memorize it and record it with your phone.

Why are we doing this?

- You practice speech skills: volume, eye contact, organization, and presenting information about a place you know well.
- You review the pronunciation from this unit: vowel and consonant sounds, syllable stress, and linking.

How the example video is organized

The example "Top Three Things to do in San Diego" is a good model (the transcript is in your printed lesson):

- **Introduction:** the speaker's connection to the city and why it is interesting: *I was born and raised in San Diego, and it's also a well-known tourist destination.* Then: *Here's my list of the 3 best things to do in San Diego.*
- **Three places:** for each one, a few sentences: what it is, a fact, and what you can do there (*You can go on a tour..., taste excellent Mexican food, and listen to live music.*).

How your video is graded (rubric, 50 points)

There are 5 parts. Each part gets 10 (excellent), 7 (good), 5 (needs improvement) or 0 points. With 5 or 0 points in a part, the book asks you to make the video again.

1. **Content:** the name of the place and 3 interesting sites; why each place is important or interesting; 3 phrases from the "25 Things..." video; 2-4 minutes long. (All four = 10 points.)
2. **Organization and clarity:** the speech is well organized, interesting and clear.
3. **Delivery:** you speak loudly enough, look directly at the camera, and speak confidently with little help from notes.
4. **Pronunciation:** syllable stress, vowel and consonant sounds, and linking are clear and easy to understand.
5. **Visuals:** at least 3 pictures, one for each place.

Practice

1. Study the example. Watch "Top Three Things to do in San Diego" (link below) and read the transcript in your printed lesson. Answer: a) What are the three places? b) Find the sentences with these phrases: one of the largest; dates back to; You can't come to ... and not ...; head over to.

2. Brainstorm and plan. Think of a city (or other interesting location) you know well. Choose 3 places in that city. Brainstorm things a tourist can do in each place. Write notes: | | Place | Why it is important or interesting | Things a tourist can do | Picture | |---|---|---|---|---| | 1 | | | | | | 2 | | | | | | 3 | | | | |

3. Functional language. Write one sentence about your city with each phrase. Book example: *The Empire State Building is one of the largest buildings in New York City*.

- one of the largest
- dates back to
- You can't come to ... and not ...
- head over to
- This ... (place) actually used to be ...
- Every ... (day, week, month) people flock to ...

4. Write your draft. See the Writing task below.

5. Practice and memorize. Read your draft aloud many times. Mark the stressed syllable in long words and mark the links (for example, one_of, head_over). Practice until you can say it without notes. Time yourself: 2 to 4 minutes.

6. Record your video. Use your phone. Look directly at the camera and speak loudly enough. Show your 3 pictures. Then watch your video and score it with the rubric (_____ / 50). If any part gets 5 or 0 points, practice and record again.

7. After the project. In the book, classmates watch each other's videos and post comments. Instead: present your tour to your tutor in Live conversation and answer the tutor's questions. Then write one thoughtful comment or question about the example San Diego video.

Speak with your tutor

- "I am planning a short video tour of my city. Ask me questions about three places in my city, one at a time."
- "You are a tourist. Ask me what to do in my city. I will answer with 'head over to', 'dates back to' and 'You can't come to ... and not ...'."
- "Listen to my presentation. Time it, and tell me which phrases from the Berlin video I used."
- "After my presentation, ask me two questions like a viewer would. Then tell me one thing I did well and one thing to improve."
- "Listen to my presentation again and tell me which words were hard to understand."

Read aloud

1. I was born and raised in San Di·E·go. (↘)
2. It's also a well-known tourist des·ti·NA·tion. (↘)
3. There are mu·SE·ums, green spaces, RES·tau·rants, FOUN·tains, THE·a·ters and a bo·TAN·i·cal GAR·den. (↘)
4. Old Town, San Diego dates back to the 18th CEN·tu·ry. (↘)
5. It's the site of the first Spanish SET·tle·ment in Cal·i·FOR·nia. (↘)
6. You can't come to San Di·E·go and not visit the beaches. (↘)

Writing task

Write the draft of your presentation (the book calls it a rough draft).

- Start with an introduction: name the city and say why it is important to you.
- Write 2-3 sentences about each of your 3 places: what it is, why it is interesting, and what a tourist can do there.
- Use at least 3 phrases from the Functional language list (exercise 3).
- Make it long enough for a 2-4 minute presentation.

(example answer, one place) *The old market dates back to the 15th century. It is one of the largest markets in my city. You can't come to my city and not drink coffee there.*

Watch online

- Example video, Top Three Things to do in San Diego: https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=loA3PCyv9Io
- 25 Things to do in Berlin (review the phrases): https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=lw5NHQeXzpA

Answer key

1. a) Balboa Park, Old Town, and the beaches (the speaker's favorite beach is Mission Bay). b) "Balboa Park is one of the largest parks in San Diego covering 1,200 acres." / "Old Town, San Diego dates back to the 18th century..." / "You can't come to San Diego and not visit the beaches." / "You can also head over to Belmont Park to ride the roller coaster..."
2. (example answer) Place 1: the old market. It is important to me because I went there with my grandfather. Tourists can buy spices and drink coffee.
3. (example answer)
    - The central park is one of the largest parks in my city.
    - The old mosque dates back to the 15th century.
    - You can't come to my city and not try the fresh bread from the old market.
    - In the evening, head over to the beach to watch the sunset.
    - This cafe actually used to be an old house.
    - Every Friday people flock to the park for picnics.
4. See the model in the Writing task. 5.-6. No key. Use the rubric.
7. (example answer) Great video! I would love to visit Old Town. Is the Whaley House really haunted?

My notes